# INTRODUCTORY SOMMELIER COURSE AND EXAM

## AND

# CERTIFIED SOMMELIER THEORY EXAM

## CURRICULUM GUIDE

# INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

## Subject Name: WORLD SPARKLING WINES

**Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course:** After studying this section, a student will understand the different ways sparkling wines are made.

**Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam:** After studying this section, a Certified Sommelier will understand the different ways sparkling wines are made, be able to identify the method used for the world's most important sparkling wines, and describe the impact the method has on the final wine. A Certified Sommelier will be able to recommend sparkling wines to guests and pair them appropriately with food.

| | Introductory Level | Certified Sommelier Exam |
|---|---|---|
| **Winemaking:**<br>**Classic / Traditional Method** | **Also called Champagne Method, Méthode Traditionnelle, Metodo Classico**<br>Making still wine, assemblage of Cuvée, creating bubbles using Liqueur de Tirage, Sur Lie Aging, Riddling (Rémuage) using pupitre or gyropalette, Disgorging (Dégorgement), Dosage using Liqueur d'Expédition. Autolysis. Aging in lees.<br><br>**Examples:** Champagne, Crémant, Cava, Franciacorta | Making still wine, assemblage of Cuvée, Creating bubbles using Liqueur de tirage, Sur Lie Aging, Riddling (Remuage) using pupitre or gyropalette, Disgorging (Dégorgement), Dosage using Liqueur d'expédition. **Know what liqueur de tirage and liqueur d'expédition are made of.<br><br>**Examples:** Cap Classique |
| **Winemaking:**<br>**Transfer Method** | Identical to the classic method up to completion of second fermentation. Secondary fermentation occurs in bottle. The bottles are disgorged under pressure into large tanks. The wine is then filtered and then rebottled. **Advantages:** Lees contact for flavor is obtained and riddling is eliminated.<br><br>**Examples:** This process is used for extra large and extra small format bottles. | |
| **Winemaking:**<br>**Charmat Method - Cuve Close** | Secondary fermentation occurs in pressurized tanks. Fermentation is complete in 4-5 days. The wine is filtered and then bottled. **Advantages:** Saves an immense amount of time and cost with no riddling or disgorging. Can be as little as 90 days from harvest to final bottling. This is the best process for making sparkling wine from aromatic grape varieties.<br><br>**Examples:** Prosecco, Moscato d'Asti | **Examples:** Lambrusco |
| **Winemaking:**<br>**Méthod Ancestrale** | Primary fermentation is paused mid-way. The wines are bottled and the fermentation finishes inside the bottle. The $CO_2$ produced is trapped in the bottle. There is no requirement to remove the sediment by disgorging. | Also called Ancestral Method / Méthode Rurale / Pétillant Naturel (a.k.a. "Pet-nat"). Bottled at much lower pressure. |

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| | Introductory Level | Certified Sommelier Exam |
|---|---|---|
| **Food and Beverage Pairing** | | Differences between possible pairings depending on the method. How does the method impact the final style? |
| **BOS** | | Impact of cost of these various styles and how they fit into a well rounded wine program both by the bottle and by the glass to offer guests many price points. |
| **Label Terms** | **Crémant:** French sparkling wine produced by méthode traditionnelle made outside the Champagne Region.<br><br>**Examples:** Crémant de Bourgogne, Crémant d'Alsace, Crémant de Loire | |
| **General Terms** | Gyropalette | Understand the importance of the Gyropalette time, cost, and efficacy. |

# INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

## Subject Name: SWEET WINES

**Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course:** After studying this section, a student will learn the different methods of sweet wine production and will review the most well-known wines and their grape varieties.

**Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam:** After studying this section, a candidate will gain a deeper knowledge of the sweet wines of the world, know iconic producers, and be able to recommend sweet wines to guests and pair them appropriately with food.

| | Introductory Level | Certified Sommelier Exam |
|---|---|---|
| **Geography:** Location | | |
| **Geography: Appellation**<br>**Noble Rot** | **Noble Rot (Botrytis)**<br>**Bordeaux:** Sauternes<br>**Alsace:** Vendange Tardive (VT) and Sélection de Grain Nobles (SGN)<br>**Germany:** Auslese, Beerenauslese (BA), Trockenbeerenauslese (TBA)<br>**Loire:** Quarts de Chaume/Bonnezeaux/Vouvray Moelleux<br>**Hungary:** Tokaji Aszú | **Match these appellations with their larger regions and know they most common grape varieties for each.** |
| **Geography: Appellation**<br>**Drying** | **Italy:** Vin Santo DOC, Recioto di Soave DOC, Recioto della Valpolicella DOC | |
| **Geography: Appellation**<br>**Freezing** | **Germany & Austria:** Eiswein<br>**Canada:** Icewine (Ontario VQA 'Vintners Quality Alliance') | |
| **Soil:** Type and/or Name | | |
| **Grape Growing** | | Eiswein and Icewine must be free of noble rot. |
| **Winemaking** | Stop the action of yeast by:<br>- Chilling and filtering<br>- Chilling and adding $SO_2$ | |
| **Wine: Grape Variety Names**<br>**Noble Rot** | **Sauternes:** Sémillon<br>**Alsace:** Riesling, Pinot Gris, Gewürztraminer, Muscat<br>**Loire Valley:** Chenin Blanc<br>**Tokaji**: Furmint | |
| **Wine: Grape Variety Names**<br>**Drying** | | **Vin Santo:** Trebbiano<br>**Recioto di Soave:** Garganega<br>**Recioto della Valpolicella:** Corvina |
| **Wine: Grape Variety Names Freezing** | **Germany:** Riesling<br>**Canada:** Riesling, Cabernet Franc | **Canada:** Vidal, Riesling, Cabernet Franc |

# INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

## Subject Name: SWEET WINES

| | Introductory Level | Certified Sommelier Exam |
|---|---|---|
| **Wine Law** | | |
| **Label Terms** | Recioto, Vendange Tardive, Sélection de Grains Nobles, Moelleux | |
| **General Terms** | Noble Rot = Botrytis Cinerea | |
| **Style** | | |
| **Classification** | | **Classification of Sauternes (1855)**<br>Superior First Growth (Premier Cru Supérieur) |
| **Producer/Proprietary Brand** | | **Château d'Yquem**<br>Know a couple of producers in each category for recommending in service. |
| **Vintage** | | |
| **History & Lore** | | |
| **Service of Beverage** | | A by-the-glass serving is usually 2 oz (59.1ml).<br>Open bottles can typically last for a week if kept cold in the refrigerator. |
| **Food and Beverage Pairing** | | Match the weight of the dessert and the wine. The wine should be sweeter than the dessert being paired.<br>Contrast sweet wines to fatty and salty foods such as foie gras and blue cheese.<br>Really old wines become drier over time. |
| **Business of the Sommelier** | | Many of these wines are bottled in clear bottles.<br>They can age for a very long time but should be kept out of direct light.<br>Full-sized bottles age better than half bottles.<br>Tokaji is often bottled in 500ml bottles, cost by the glass correctly. |

# INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

## Subject Name: FORTIFIED WINES

**Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course:** After studying this section, a student will be able to identify major fortified wines, their styles, and the grape varieties typically used in their production.

**Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam:** After studying this section, a candidate will understand the unique winemaking techniques used to make fortified wines. Certified Sommeliers will know iconic producers and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with fortified wines to a guest.

| | Introductory Level | Certified Sommelier Exam |
|---|---|---|
| **Geography:** Location | | Be able to identify major regions on a map. |
| **Geography:** Appellation - **Port** | Same geographical area as Douro DOP, Portugal. | **Subregions:** Cima Corgo, Baixo Corgo, Douro Superior |
| **Geography:** Appellation - **Madeira** | Island located near North Africa | Funchal is the main city on the island Madeira. |
| **Geography:** Appellation - **Sherry** | Southwest Spain | Jerez-Xérès-Sherry, Sanlúcar de Barrameda on the coast. |
| **Geography:** Appellation - **Marsala** | Sicily, Italy | **Marsala DOC** |
| **Geography:** Appellation - **French Fortified Wines** | **Roussillon:** Banyuls AOP<br>**Southern Rhône:** Muscat de Beaumes-de-Venise AOP | |
| **Geography:** Appellations - **Other** | | **Australia:** Rutherglen, Victoria<br>**South Africa:** Klein Karoo, Western Cape |
| **Geography:** Climate Categories | | **Madeira:** Hot Subtropical<br>**Sherry:** Hot Maritime<br>**Port:** Warm to hot Mediterranean |
| **Geography:** Physical Feature | | **Madeira**: Mountainous hillside<br>**Sherry**: Close proximity to the Atlantic<br>**Port:** Mountainous hillside |
| **Soil:** Type and/or Name | **Port:** Schist<br>**Madeira:** Volcanic<br>**Sherry:** Albariza (chalk) | **Sherry:** Barros (clay), Arenas (sand) |
| **Grape Growing** | | |
| **Winemaking - Port** | Fortified during fermentation. | |
| **Winemaking - Madeira** | Fortified during fermentation, oxidized, exposed to heat. | **Know estufagem** and **canteiro.**<br>Sweeter styles are fortified closer to the beginning of fermentation. |
| **Winemaking - Sherry** | Fortified after fermentation, oxidized. | **Flor:** Saccharomyces cerevisiae.<br>Biological aging vs. oxidative aging.<br>Running the scales of the Solera. |

# INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

## Subject Name: FORTIFIED WINES

| | Introductory Level | Certified Sommelier Exam |
|---|---|---|
| **Wine:** Grape Variety Names | **Port:** Touriga Nacional<br>**Madeira:** Sercial, Verdelho, Bual, Malmsey, Tinta Negra<br>**Sherry:** Palomino, Moscatel, Pedro Ximénez<br>**Banyuls**: Grenache<br>**Muscat de Beaumes-de-Venise:** Muscat | **Rutherglen**: Muscat<br>**Klein Karoo**: Muscat de Frontignan and Muscat à Petits Grains |
| **Wine Law** | | |
| **Label Terms** | | **Port:** Late Bottled Vintage (LBV), Single Quinta, Vintage |
| **General Terms** | | **Port:** Vila Nova de Gaia |
| **Style - Port** | **Ruby:** Basic Ruby, Late Bottled Vintage (LBV), Single Quinta, Vintage<br>**Aged Tawny:** 10-year, 20-year, 30-year, 40-year | **Aged Tawny:** Colheita (min 7 years aging) |
| **Style - Madeira** | **In order of driest to sweetest style:** Sercial, Verdelho, Bual, Malmsey | |
| **Style - Sherry** | Biological aging vs. Oxidative aging | **Biological:** Manzanilla, Fino, Amontillado, Palo Cortado<br>**Oxidative:** Oloroso, Cream Sherry |
| **Style - Marsala** | | Secco, Semi-Secco, Dolce |
| **Classification** | | |
| **Producer** | | |
| **Vintage** | | Understand vintage Port is only made in the best vintages. |
| **History & Lore** | | |
| **Service of Beverage** | | Old Vintage and Single Quinta Ports require decanting for sediment.<br>By-the-glass pours are typically 2 oz (51.9 ml).<br>Refer to the CMS Hospitality and Service Standards for proper service temperatures. |
| **Food and Beverage Pairing** | | Understand how sweetness, age, and amount of oxidation can affect a pairing with these wines. |
| **Business of the Sommelier** | | Know general shelf life of the wine after opening. |